Launching Rapid Drug Test Kits in Botswana

Proposal by Vansen Medical Investments (Pvt) Ltd · October 2026

The opportunity: Vansen Medical proposes a Botswana-specific rapid urine test cup, branded in Setswana, for schools, clinics, workplaces and rehabilitation services in 2027. The Drug Enforcement Agency reports that **44–45% of secondary school learners** used a substance in the past year, and **31%** met the criteria for a substance use disorder. The National Drug Control Master Strategy (2026–2030) pairs prevention, treatment and rehabilitation; fast, low-cost screening is the missing first step.

A panel built for Botswana

Strip	Detects	Why it is on the panel
THC	Cannabis (dagga)	Most-used illicit drug nationally
MCAT	Methcathinone (CAT)	Second most abused; rising in schools
COC	Cocaine and crack	Top-three drug in Gaborone hotspots
MET/AMP	Crystal meth, amphetamines	Growing synthetic-drug threat
MOP/OPI	Heroin, nyaope, codeine syrup	Heroin spreading; codeine misuse in learners
MQL	Methaqualone (mandrax)	Named by police as common
BZO	Benzodiazepines	Prescription-drug misuse
ETG	**Alcohol (up to 80 hrs)**	**Most-used substance among youth**
hCG	**Pregnancy**	**Clinics, women's health, pre-employment**

Highlighted rows are the new alcohol and pregnancy strips. The pregnancy strip is used only with informed consent; results stay with the clinician.

Brand name in Setswana

Boammaaruri Cup

"The truth" — Botswana's counterpart to Zimbabwe's Chokwadi Cup
Alternative: **Pholo Cup** ("health, healing") for clinics and rehab

Bilingual packaging (Setswana and English). Final name to be confirmed by youth groups and a native-speaker reviewer.

Public awareness on social media

- **Channels:** Facebook, WhatsApp, TikTok, Instagram; Yarona FM, Duma FM and RB2 radio for rural reach.
- **Message:** "Know the truth, get help early" — screening as a door to treatment, not punishment.
- **Voices:** Batswana musicians, athletes and people in recovery; short Setswana videos under **#BoammaaruriBW**.
- **Moments:** January school opening and World Drug Day (26 June).
- **Proof:** monthly public dashboard of kits distributed and referrals made.

Stakeholders, NGOs and funders

Government partners

- Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA) – lead sponsor
- Ministry of Health – substance abuse division
- BoMRA – product registration
- Ministry of basic education – schools
- Botswana Police – narcotics unit; Botswana Prison Service

Botswana NGOs

- BOSASNet – Botswana Substance Abuse Support Network
- ISSUP Botswana (BAAP) – addiction professionals
- Captive Eye Organisation – community outreach
- BOFWA – Botswana Family Welfare Association
- Stepping Stones International (youth); Botswana Red Cross Society

International funders

- Gates Foundation – screening and data pilots
- World Health Organization – technical guidance
- World Bank Group – health system financing
- African Development Bank – youth programs
- UNICEF (schools) · UNODC Southern Africa (treatment) · UNFPA (women's health) · Global Fund

Private sector and media

- Debswana and mining houses – workforce testing
- Pharmacies and private clinics – retail sales
- Mascom, Orange, BTC – SMS and data campaigns
- Yarona FM, Duma FM, Btv – public awareness
- Churches and dikgosi – community trust

Rollout and the ask

1 · Nov–Dec 2026 — Approvals
Register the cup with BoMRA; brief the DEA and Ministry of Health.

2 · Jan–Mar 2027 — Pilot
Gaborone and Francistown schools, clinics, one mine, one rehab centre; train teachers, nurses, counsellors.

3 · Apr–Jun 2027 — Scale
National rollout, launched publicly on World Drug Day, 26 June 2027.

We ask partners to: co-fund the pilot, endorse a screening-to-treatment referral pathway, and open doors to ministries and NGO networks.

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Sources: Botswana Daily News (Jul 2026, Feb 2026), Mmegi, ISSUP Botswana, UNODC Southern Africa.